

# Magtym Ussayev

DevOps Engineer

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*Languages: Russian (Native), English (B2, working proficiency)*

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## About Me

DevOps Engineer with 6 years building cloud-native infrastructure across FinTech, Blockchain, and SaaS domains, and 4 years in systems administration prior. I specialize in Kubernetes at scale, GitOps workflows, and DevSecOps practices. Passionate about reducing operational costs and deployment friction through automation, observability, and thoughtful architectural design.

## Selected Achievements

- **Led full-stack migration to Kubernetes across all 3 environments: staging and production from ECS to EKS, and dev from bare-metal to EKS** — unifying deployment tooling and enabling consistent GitOps workflows platform-wide
- **Reduced Docker image size 20×** (300MB → 15MB) across 20+ Golang microservices via multi-stage builds and distroless base images
- **Achieved 99.9% production uptime** for blockchain validator infrastructure across multiple AWS regions
- **Cut AWS infrastructure costs ~30%** through Spot instances, Karpenter node auto-scaling, and right-sized EKS resource allocation
- **Migrated deployment pipeline to fully automated GitOps with ArgoCD**, reducing release time from hours to minutes
- **Built automated PostgreSQL/blockchain snapshot backup system** with S3 lifecycle policies, ensuring RPO < 1 hour
- **Migrated 3 environments (staging, prod, dev)** from manually-managed EKS secrets to chart-managed ExternalSecrets, enabling developer self-service for env variables via PRs

## Key Skills

**Cloud:** AWS (EKS, EC2, S3, RDS/Aurora, ElastiCache, Route 53, CloudFront), GCP, Hetzner, Selectel

**Containers & Orchestration:** Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, Karpenter, Traefik

**GitOps & CI/CD:** ArgoCD, GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Harbor

**Infrastructure as Code:** Terraform, Ansible, Vagrant

**Security (DevSecOps):** HashiCorp Vault, mTLS, ModSecurity, OWASP, NGFW, SIEM/SOC

**Observability:** Prometheus, Grafana, Sentry, ELK Stack, Zabbix, Graylog

**Databases:** PostgreSQL, Redis, MongoDB

**Languages:** Go, Python, Bash

**Systems:** Linux (Debian, CentOS, Ubuntu), FreeBSD, Windows Server

## Work Experience

### DevOps Engineer — Videfy (LivesPro)

2025 – Present | AI-powered video generation SaaS platform

Own the Kubernetes platform across three environments (staging, production, dev), driving migration from manual EKS-repo secret management to a fully chart-managed, self-service model for developers.

#### Platform Migration

- Led full-stack migration to Kubernetes across **all 3 environments**: staging and production from **ECS to EKS**, and dev from **bare-metal to EKS**, unifying deployment tooling, observability, and secrets management under a single Kubernetes-based platform
- Re-architected CI/CD and GitOps pipelines to work uniformly across the newly unified EKS environments, replacing environment-specific manual deployment processes inherited from ECS and bare-metal setups

#### Platform & GitOps

- Migrated env configuration across **3 environments** (staging, prod, dev) from inline EKS-repo secrets to chart-managed **ExternalSecrets + ConfigMaps**, enabling developers to add/rotate env variables via chart PRs without DevOps involvement
- Refactored Helm chart architecture: parametrized **envFrom.secretRef** via **.Values.externalSecrets.name**, consolidated duplicate worker deployment templates, moved shared config to base **values.yaml** with per-env overrides
- Built **ArgoCD Application layout** for backend, mediaconversion workers, and token-balancer across 3 environments; established production-safe sync patterns (image tag pinning, pre-delete for immutable Deployment fields)

#### Secrets & Multi-Cluster

- Integrated **External Secrets Operator** with AWS Secrets Manager across all 3 EKS environments: separate SecretStores per environment, IRSA-based auth on staging/prod, migrated dev from static IAM Secret-based auth (bare-metal) to IRSA post-EKS-migration
- Automated propagation of AWS SM secret rotations into **Kubernetes Secrets consumed via envFrom**; removed hardcoded secret references from templates to prevent env-specific breakage

#### Networking & Routing

- Configured multi-layer routing: **Gateway API HTTPRoute → Traefik → AWS ALB → CloudFront**, with TLS termination at ALB using ACM certificates
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**Tech stack:** AWS (EKS, EC2, S3, RDS Aurora, ElastiCache, ACM, ALB, CloudFront, Secrets Manager, SQS), Kubernetes, Helm, ArgoCD, External Secrets Operator, Gateway API, Traefik, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, Redis, RabbitMQ, Node.js

### DevOps Engineer — Nodigy (Blockchain / Web3)

2020 – 2025 | Team: 2 DevOps, 4 Backend (Go), 2 Frontend, 1 QA

Building and maintaining production blockchain infrastructure on AWS EKS with a strong focus on GitOps, security, and cost optimization.

#### Infrastructure & Platform

- Deployed and maintained **full nodes and RPC endpoints** for multiple blockchain networks across HA multi-region AWS setups, ensuring low-latency data access for downstream services

- Migrated legacy manual deployments to a full **GitOps workflow with ArgoCD**, automating the lifecycle of microservices and smart contract releases end-to-end
- Reduced Docker image size **from 300MB+ to 15MB** across all Go services via multi-stage builds and distroless bases, cutting registry storage and pull times significantly

### Cost & Performance

- Cut AWS infrastructure spend by **~30%** through Spot instances, Karpenter-based auto-scaling, and fine-tuned EC2/EKS resource requests
- Optimized cluster autoscaling policies to reduce cold-start latency during traffic bursts

### Reliability & Observability

- Achieved **99.9% uptime** for production services via multi-AZ deployments, health-check-driven failover, and proactive monitoring
- Developed **custom Prometheus exporters** for blockchain-specific metrics (block height, peer count, sync status), enabling proactive incident detection
- Built dashboards and alerting in Grafana with routing to on-call rotation

### Security & Data

- Implemented secure key management for validator private keys with **HashiCorp Vault** and isolated network segments
- Secured internal and public APIs using **mTLS with client certificates** enforced at the Nginx edge
- Built automated containerized backup pipeline for **PostgreSQL (RDS) and blockchain snapshots** with S3 lifecycle policies and scheduled retention (RPO < 1h)

**Tech stack:** AWS (EKS, EC2, S3, RDS Aurora, ElastiCache, Route 53, CloudFront), Kubernetes, Karpenter, Docker, ArgoCD, GitLab CI/CD, Terraform, Ansible, Prometheus, Grafana, ELK, PostgreSQL, Redis, Nginx (mTLS), HashiCorp Vault

## System Administrator — Telecom

2016 – 2020 | Team: 4 SysAdmins, 2 Network Engineers, 5-person Support Team

Ran core infrastructure for a regional telecom provider, supporting 24/7 uptime for critical business services.

- Maintained **high-load Linux/FreeBSD/Windows** server environment; achieved consistent uptime across core services through proactive monitoring and multi-tier disaster recovery
- Designed and operated **virtualization clusters** on Proxmox and VMware ESXi with HA failover, minimizing downtime during hardware failures
- Built **Zabbix + Graylog monitoring stack** with proactive alerting rules, reducing mean incident response time significantly
- Configured Cisco / Juniper / HP networking equipment: VLANs, OSPF/BGP routing, firewall policies
- Implemented multi-tier backup and disaster recovery strategy ensuring data integrity and rapid restoration

**Tech stack:** Linux, FreeBSD, Windows Server, Proxmox, VMware ESXi, Zabbix, Graylog, Cisco/Juniper networking, Nginx, Apache

## Education & Certifications

- **BSc in Information Technology** — Tver State Technical University
- **PCNSA** — Palo Alto Networks Certified Network Security Administrator
- **SOC Certification** — Positive Technologies